

Website Go-Live & Domain Handover

Everything needed to point your new domain at the live website, and the short checklist of details to send back so we can confirm it's all correct.

PREPARED FOR Adrian Wilkinson	HOSTED ON Vercel	NEW DOMAIN [yournewdomain.com]	DATE 31 May 2026
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What's happening

Your website is built and hosted on **Vercel**. We're moving it onto your new domain, **[yournewdomain.com]**. For the site to appear on that address, your domain needs two small **DNS records** pointing at Vercel. You add these once at the company where you bought the domain (your "registrar"), and Vercel handles the rest — including the secure padlock (SSL certificate) automatically.

After the records are saved, the change can take **anywhere up to 24–48 hours** to fully roll out across the internet (this is called *DNS propagation*). It's often much quicker, but please don't worry if it isn't instant everywhere.

The three-step picture

① You add 2 DNS records at your registrar → ② We verify the domain inside Vercel → ③ Site goes live with secure HTTPS, automatically.

1 The DNS records to add

Add the following two records in your domain's DNS settings. These are the standard values Vercel uses for every site it hosts.

Type	Name / Host	Value / Points to	TTL
A	@ (the root domain)	76.76.21.21	Auto / 3600
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com	Auto / 3600

A couple of notes on the table

- **"@" / root:** many registrars show the root domain as @, or as a blank box, or as your full domain name — they all mean the same thing.
- **Don't add http:// or a trailing slash** to the values — just the plain text shown above (e.g. 76.76.21.21).
- **TTL** (time to live) can be left on the default/automatic setting — a lower value just means changes refresh a little faster.

! IMPORTANT — remove conflicting records

If there are **existing A records** on “@” or an **existing CNAME / record** on “www” pointing at an old host (your previous site, a “parked” page, a site-builder, etc.), please **delete those old ones** so they don’t fight with the new records. Two A records on the root pointing to different places will make the site load inconsistently.

Don’t touch your email records

If you use email on this domain (e.g. `you@[yournewdomain.com]`), leave any **MX records** and related entries (SPF / TXT / DKIM) exactly as they are. We’re only adding/adjusting the website records (A and www). If you’re not sure, send us a screenshot of the full DNS list *before* changing anything and we’ll point out precisely what to keep.

2 How to add them (any registrar)

The wording differs slightly between providers (GoDaddy, Namecheap, 123-Reg, Cloudflare, etc.), but the path is essentially the same:

- 1 Log in to the company where you **bought / registered the domain**.
- 2 Find **My Domains** (or “Domain List”), and open `[yournewdomain.com]`.
- 3 Open **DNS / DNS Management / Advanced DNS / Manage DNS**.
- 4 Add the **A record** from the table above (Name @, Value `76.76.21.21`).
- 5 Add the **CNAME record** (Name `www`, Value `cname.vercel-dns.com`).
- 6 **Save**. Remove any old conflicting A/www records (see the warning above).

Using Cloudflare?

Set both records’ proxy status to “**DNS only**” (**grey cloud, not orange**) so Vercel can issue the SSL certificate. You can re-enable the proxy later if needed.

3 What to send back to me

To make this as simple as possible, once you’ve saved the records just send me the following. With these I can verify the domain inside Vercel and confirm the site is pointing correctly — you won’t need to do anything technical beyond this.

» **The exact domain name**

confirmed spelling, e.g. [yournewdomain.com] — and whether you want the **www** or the **non-www** version to be the main address.

» **A screenshot of your DNS records**

the page showing the A and www/CNAME records after saving. This lets me confirm the values are exactly right.

» **Your domain registrar name**

who you bought the domain from (GoDaddy, Namecheap, 123-Reg, etc.) — handy if anything needs adjusting.

» **Confirmation about email**

let me know if you use email on this domain, so we protect those records.

If you'd rather I just do it all for you

Two easy options instead of adding records yourself:

- **Add me to your DNS:** most registrars let you invite a “delegate” or extra user to the domain’s DNS only (not billing). Send an invite and I’ll add the records.
- **Or share a temporary login:** if your registrar doesn’t support delegate access, you can share a login securely and I’ll set everything up, then you change the password afterwards.

4 After it’s pointed — what to expect

- **Propagation up to 24–48 hours:** the site may appear for you before it appears for someone else — that’s normal while the change rolls out.
- **Secure padlock (HTTPS):** Vercel issues the SSL certificate automatically once the domain is verified. A brief “not secure” warning during setup is expected and clears on its own.
- **Both www and non-www will work:** visitors typing either version will land on the site, redirecting to your chosen main address.
- **How to check:** open the site in a **private/incognito window**, or test on mobile data (not wifi), to avoid your browser showing an old cached version.

Quick troubleshooting

Site not showing yet	Most likely still propagating — give it a few hours. Test in incognito or on mobile data.
“Invalid configuration” in Vercel	Usually an old A/www record still in place. Remove conflicting records.
No padlock / “not secure”	Certificate is still being issued — clears automatically once DNS resolves.
Email stopped working	An MX/TXT record was likely changed. Send a screenshot and we’ll restore it.

Any questions, just send them over.

Send your checklist items (Section 3) to me directly and I’ll confirm the moment the site is verified and live.